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TYPES OF UPPER RESPIRATORY TRACT INFECTIONS

X = None or rare
 ? = Possible
 Y = Common (Yes)

	Allergic rhinitis	COVID	Influenza	Pharyngitis	Rhinosinusitis	Viral rhinitis (common cold)
Etiology	Non-infectious	Viral	Viral	Viral > bacterial	Viral > bacterial > fungal	Viral
Fever	X	Y	Y: Sudden onset	Viral: Low-grade Bacterial: High-grade	? Early in illness	X
Headache	Y (Due to sinus congestion)	?	Y	Y	Y (Due to sinus congestion)	X (May occur due to sinus congestion)
Body aches	Ear aches (children)	Y: Myalgia	Y: Myalgia	? Especially if bacterial	X	X
Nasal symptoms	Y: Lots of clear discharge, sneezing (congestion?)	Y: Rhinorrhea	Y: Clear at the beginning then mucopurulent	? Rhinorrhea in viral cases	Y: Purulent green/yellow rhinorrhea + nasal congestion	Y: Clear at the beginning then mucopurulent + nasal congestion
Cough	? Post-nasal drip	Y: Dry	Y: Non-productive	X	? Post-nasal drip	Y: Dry initially then productive
Sore throat	? Upon awakening	Y	Y	Y: Sudden	? Upon awakening	Y

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	Allergic rhinitis	COVID	Influenza	Pharyngitis	Rhinosinusitis	Viral rhinitis (common cold)
Comments	Lacrimation, pruritus (eyes/nose/ears/throat)	Loss of smell, taste, appetite, SOB, fatigue Lasts up to 14 days generally	N/V, fatigue, chills, malaise Lasts 10 days	Pain when swallowing Viral: watery eyes and sneezing. Symptoms lasts 5-7 days. Bacterial: N/V, symptoms improve 1-2 days after starting antibiotic.	Jaw/tooth/ear pain, facial tenderness, hyposmia, anosmia, halitosis (bacterial). Viral symptoms last for maximum 10 days whereas bacterial symptoms worsen within first 3-4 days and then persist for >10 days.	Lacrimation sneezing initially Usually 5-7 days (up to 14 days)
Treatment	Symptom management	Symptom management May consider nirmatrelvir/ritonavir (Paxlovid®) after positive viral test within 3-5 days of symptom onset	Symptom treatment Neuraminidase inhibitors (oseltamivir/zanamivir) within 48 hours of symptoms or for prevention (note: avoid administration 48 hours prior to and for 2 weeks after influenza vaccine	Symptomatic management If GAS: penicillin V or amoxicillin	Symptom management. Watchful waiting for up to 7 days. If no improvement, or symptoms are worsening, consider bacterial etiology. Treat bacterial cases with amoxicillin (Step pneu, H influenzae, Moraxella catarrhalis).	Symptom management

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